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The Medicaid Long-Term Planning Checklist

What to keep organized, notice and ask about when you're planning ahead for Dad.

Dad is managing on his own, and Medicaid is a “someday, maybe” in your family. You don't need to know any rules to use this list: it names the records worth keeping organized, the everyday changes worth noticing, and the questions worth writing down for later. Go through it with Dad's say-so and check what you've done. Anything unchecked is something to get to when it suits you both, not a verdict about Dad or about you.

Keep organized

- [ ] Dad's financial records: the statements for each account and his income paperwork, with a note of where each is kept. [1]
- [ ] His important legal documents, and where the signed originals are.
- [ ] His insurance and care-related paperwork, kept with the rest.
- [ ] One safe place for all of it, on paper or online, and a second person Dad trusts who knows where it is. [1]
- [ ] A family contact list, and the names and numbers of the professionals Dad already uses. [1]
- [ ] The name of the person Dad would want handling the mail and Medicaid matters if he ever needed it, written down in his words.

Notice

- [ ] Financial changes: income that starts or stops, an account opened or closed, something bought or sold. Write the date and what happened.
- [ ] Changes in where Dad lives, or in who lives with him.
- [ ] Significant changes in his health, or in the help he gets.
- [ ] Money that may arrive one day, such as an inheritance, a gift or the proceeds of a sale. Write down that it's expected, and who knows about it.

Ask about

- [ ] A question to write down for your Medicaid planner: after a Medicaid approval, what does ongoing eligibility involve in general terms, from notices and renewals to changes in circumstances and recordkeeping?
- [ ] Another: of the changes on our list, which would you want to look at with us before anyone acts?
- [ ] And one for the family: when will we look at all of this again, and which events would bring us back to it sooner?

What this checklist doesn't do

It helps you keep, notice and ask. It doesn't say what Medicaid requires after an approval in Dad's state, whether any change on your list matters or would have to be reported, or whether Dad will ever need Medicaid. Rules vary by state, so those questions go to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've been through what to keep organized, what to notice and what to ask about, a whole category at a time. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Items marked 1 follow the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau's advice on keeping financial documents and professional contacts organized and letting someone you trust know where to find them. The rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Planning for diminished capacity and illness